



Eid Al-Adha
MUBARAK



800 916
www.abcargo.com



GULF NEWS
WISHES ITS
READERS
EID
MUBARAK

■ Pilgrims gather on top of the rocky hill known as the Mountain of Mercy, on the Plain of Arafat, during the annual Haj pilgrimage near Makkah, Saudi Arabia, yesterday.

Worshippers brave the heat to pray as Haj reaches its peak

Thousands of pilgrims recite Quranic verses from dawn on Mount Arafat in key ritual

MAKKAH

Worshippers prayed on Mount Arafat in the high point of the Haj pilgrimage yesterday as authorities urged them to avoid the hottest hours of the day after tragedy struck last year.

Thousands of white-robed pilgrims recited Quranic verses from dawn on the 70-metre (230 feet) rocky rise near Makkah, where the Prophet Mohammad (PBUH) is believed to have given his last sermon.

But numbers thinned by midday following official warnings for pilgrims to stay inside

1.5m

pilgrims from world over are performing Haj this year

between 10am and 4pm, a year after 1,301 people died in temperatures that hit 51.8 degrees Celsius (125 degrees Fahrenheit). "I came here early to (avoid) the sun and later I will pray inside my tent," said 54-year-old Adel Ismail, from Syria.

Authorities have taken several steps to reduce the risk from heat at the Haj, which has drawn 1.5 million pilgrims to one of the world's hottest regions. Shaded areas have been expanded by 50,000 square metres, thousands of medics are on standby

and more than 400 cooling units have been deployed.

Crackdown on offenders

The Saudis have also cracked down on unregistered, non-fee paying pilgrims, who lack access to the full amenities and made up more than 80 per cent of last year's deaths. Yesterday, icepacks were handed to people walking towards Mount Arafat, with some placing the small bags on their heads. With temperatures reaching 42C (107.6F), officials ushered people away if they spent too long in one place near the bouldered hill, which had fans spraying mist and cool air at its foot.

After sunset the pilgrims headed to Muzdalifah where they will gather pebbles for today's symbolic "stoning of the devil".

— AFP

SEE ALSO P9

Dubai all geared up for Eid Al Adha celebrations

Public parking will be free in Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Sharjah

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter
KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

Dubai Municipality on Wednesday affirmed its full readiness to manage operations across the emirate during the Eid Al Adha holiday, deploying a field team of 2,800 engineers, supervisors, inspectors, and specialised workers.

The initiative aims to ensure high standards of public health, safety, and environmental cleanliness across public spaces, facilities, and events, the civic body said.

To ensure citywide cleanliness during the holiday, Dubai Municipality has deployed

more than 2,300 sanitation engineers, supported by 250 supervisory and inspection staff. The teams are responsible for overseeing field operations, supported by a fleet of 752 fully equipped vehicles and machinery. A team of 250 inspectors and monitors has been assigned to enforce public health and food safety standards, including inspection of event venues and food establishments.

Free parking

Public parking will be free in Dubai, Abu Dhabi and Sharjah during the Eid Al Adha holiday. Normal parking will resume on Monday.

In Dubai, Parkin announced that public parking will be free until Sunday. However, this does not apply to multi-storey parking facilities, which will operate under their regular paid tariff system.

SEE ALSO P2

NATION

New rules implemented for Emiratis opting to study abroad | P4

BUSINESS

In boost for trade ties, UAE no longer on Brazil's tax haven list | P5

INDIA

Fighter pilot takes next giant step for India's space plans | P11



Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 S.Arabia: SR 5.00 India: Rs 40.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Trump slaps travel ban on 12 countries

AFGHANISTAN, IRAN AND YEMEN AMONG NATIONS IN THE FIRING LINE

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump signed a new travel ban on Wednesday targeting 12 countries including Afghanistan, Iran and Yemen, reviving one of the most controversial measures from his first term.

Trump said the measure was spurred by a makeshift flame-thrower attack on a Jewish protest in Colorado that US authorities blamed on a man they said was in the country illegally.

The move bans all travel to the United States by nationals of Afghanistan, Myanmar, Chad, Republic of the Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Haiti, Iran, Libya, Somalia, Sudan and Yemen.

Trump also imposed a partial ban on travellers from seven countries: Burundi, Cuba, Laos, Sierra Leone, Togo, Turkmenistan and Venezuela. Some temporary work visas from these countries will be allowed.

The bans go into effect on Monday, the White House said.

'Extreme dangers'

"The recent terror attack in Boulder, Colorado has underscored the extreme dangers posed to our country by the entry of foreign nationals who are not properly vetted," Trump said in a video message from the Oval Office posted on X. The ban will not apply to athletes competing

HARVARD SAGA

Trump signed an executive action that prevents foreign nationals from entering the US to study at Harvard University, accusing the school of failing to implement discipline on campus and fostering a dramatic rise in crime.

Trump said the university had responded to a federal government request on violent, illegal or threatening campus behaviour by only identifying three foreign students enrolled at the university.

— AFP

in the 2026 World Cup, which the United States is co-hosting with Canada and Mexico, as well as the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, Trump's order said.

The US leader compared the new measures to the "powerful" ban he imposed on a number of mainly Muslim countries in his first term, which caused travel disruption across the world.

Trump said that 2017 ban had stopped the United States from suffering terror attacks that happened in Europe. "We will not let what happened in Europe happen in America," Trump said.

Venezuela hit back by warning that the United States itself was a dangerous destination.

— AFP

SEE ALSO P10



SPORT

Djokovic shows he's not done yet with win over Zverev

Serb to take on top seed Sinner for a spot in final | P12

EID SALE

UP TO 20% OFF*

Use Code: **GN25**

Scan to Follow

Flat ₹50 off on Hair dryers and ₹100 off on Vacuums

uae.jimmy.me www.amitretail.com

Permit No. 1663590